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Structure and authority in a Bedouin tribe

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The Bedouins also joke about the manner in which they practice the "pillars of Islam." Especially, they make light of the fact that they are irregular in mosque attendance. They say, with a slight smile, "we pray in the desert." A common way for an interview to end was by an informant rising and saying: "Now I must wash for prayers." This happened  267 at any time of the day! As one Bedouin put it: "According to the idea of goodness (salih), we are not good. This is because we do not pray, we are part-timers in prayer."

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